

Chapter 146-5

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Liang Shi didn't know what was so different about this term of endearment. In her view, they all carried the same amount of love.

Sometimes when she called out Xu Qingzhu's three-character name, she felt like there was honey on the tip of her tongue.

But for Xu Qingzhu, it seemed to make a huge difference.

So she could satisfy Xu Qingzhu.

But after last night, whenever she used this term of endearment, or even typed these few characters in a chat box, it felt sickeningly sweet.

Yet at the same time, she quite liked this sickeningly sweet feeling.

Soon, the day came for Liang Shi to join the crew of "Mo Journey"¹.

The day before joining the crew, Gu Yixue created a group chat with her and Sun Chengcheng, along with two supporting actresses from the production.

This was still an all-female film.

Gu Yixue was famous for filming women. The women in her lens each had their own kind of beauty—some were sensual, some were pure, some were glamorous, and some were cool and handsome.

Different people were filmed differently, and Gu Yixue could bring out all the beautiful qualities in a person to the fullest.

And she had mastered this even at a very young age.

During her days off, Liang Shi had done a lot of research on Gu Yixue.

She was exceptionally bold and very good at using newcomers.

The newcomers who had acted in her films gave outstanding performances, but their subsequent development inevitably fell into convention.

It wasn't that they weren't stunning in appearance or lacked acting skills—they simply didn't have the same spiritual quality they had shown in that film.

After looking into all this, Liang Shi became even more worried about collaborating with Gu Yixue.

However, since this was a rare opportunity, there naturally came with it a certain amount of risk.

Compared to the risk, Liang Shi felt this was more of an opportunity.

It was also her first time meeting a genius director like Gu Yixue.

After creating the group chat, Gu Yixue sent out a special announcement.

A particularly cool and aloof message, which matched Liang Shi's impression of her perfectly.

[Gu Yixue: @everyone, if anyone doesn't want to act, tell me now. I can replace people at any time. Nothing in the script is to be changed. I've already used the most appropriate words. You may be suitable for these roles, but understand that I'm the one who gives the characters their souls. Until you have sufficient ability, just do your own jobs well. If there are no objections, gather tomorrow at 3 PM at 79 Guanghua Road for a script reading session. Also, I hate people who aren't punctual.]

After seeing it, Liang Shi was the first to reply: [Received.]

The others also replied with "received" one after another.

Although Xu Qingzhu had said she wanted to wait until Liang Shi joined the crew before going on her business trip, she couldn't fight against work arrangements. She flew abroad on Tuesday and had already started adjusting to the time difference.

Leaving Liang Shi alone to guard an empty house.

When Liang Shi thought of this phrase, she surprised even herself, then smiled helplessly.

The room always felt so empty.

Xu Qingzhu wasn't there, yet it felt like Xu Qingzhu was everywhere.

She sat on the sofa and turned on the TV, which was playing a commercial featuring Yang Shuyan, showcasing Minghui Jewelry's new seasonal flagship piece.

Liang Shi casually put on a movie but couldn't muster any interest in its content—she used to be most focused when watching movies.

Halfway through, she got thirsty and stood up to go to the kitchen for water. The moment she got up, she instinctively asked: "Baby, do you want some water?"

After asking, she stood frozen in place.

After a long while, she sighed.

She seemed to instantly understand how Xu Qingzhu had felt before.

During the days when she wasn't around, Xu Qingzhu would often come back here, feeling like she should still be there.

But the house was clearly empty.

Liang Shi lost the desire to drink water. She sat woodenly on the sofa, picked up her phone intending to call Xu Qingzhu, but just then Xu Qingzhu's call came in. She immediately answered.

Before Xu Qingzhu could even speak, Liang Shi hugged a throw pillow and said somewhat pitifully: "Wifey, I miss you."

Xu Qingzhu, who had been feeling somewhat tired from jet lag, heard this and all the fatigue vanished from her face. Her eyes widened instantly, clearly filled with pleasant surprise.

Yet a moment later, she smiled and asked: "How much do you miss me?"

Liang Shi nodded: "So, so much."

Liang Shi told her what had just happened. Unexpectedly, after hearing it, Xu Qingzhu asked: "So what did you call me just now?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She raised an eyebrow: "Baby?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head: "Not in that tone."

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, coaxing her like a child: "Baby, are you tired?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded at the camera: "Tired."

The secretary, who had already walked out but returned to remind President Xu about her business trip schedule, heard what Xu Qingzhu said and felt like her ears had gone deaf.

Th-th-this... was this President Xu?

The secretary swallowed and chose to quietly leave.

Footnotes:

¹ "Mo Journey" (心途, Xīn Tú): The title literally translates to "Heart's Journey" or "Journey of the Heart." The character 心 (xīn) means "heart" or "mind," and 途 (tú) means "journey" or "path."